

Worship: Sustain Your Emotions in the Heat of Battle

In Romans 5, Paul pauses between chapters 3 and 4 and the beginning of chapter 5. He does a little side teaching on victory in afflictions and tribulation. It is almost as though he breaks out and cannot help but write this part in.

He says that not only do we glory in our position in Christ, but we also glory in tribulation when that position is challenged.

Then he goes through a process: when you enter testing and trial, immediately position yourself in the place of freedom Christ has put you in. Worship and glorify God from that position. If you do that at the beginning of every trial or affliction, a process starts that will bring you out the other end with the kind of hope that makes not ashamed.

Romans 5:1 says:

"Therefore being justified by faith,
we have peace with God
through our Lord Jesus Christ:
By whom also we have access by faith
into this grace wherein we stand,
and rejoice in hope of the glory of God."

"Therefore" means based on everything he has already said leading up to this chapter. He cannot help but burst into this truth.

Then he says:

"And not only so,
but we glory in tribulations also..."

Not for tribulations, but in the midst of them. What we glorify Him for is the position He has placed us in through grace and blood.

If I find some kind of disease trying to take me over, I know what confession does. I know the power of it. But I love adding truth to it by giving Him glory, praise, and honor, magnifying Him because in Him and by His blood I am free. I worship Him from that place until I have victory.

If you treat all tribulation and affliction that way at the entry level, this is how you will come out the other side:

"Knowing that tribulation worketh patience;
And patience, experience;
and experience, hope:
And hope maketh not ashamed..."

Tribulation employs patience when you do the right thing in tribulation. What is the right thing? Worshiping vehemently, violently, with a vengeance, positioning yourself in the place where Jesus called you free.

You can walk the floor and confess, and that is great. But when you add this fellowship with God out of your new nature, He will take care of those emotional problems.

"You are going to die."

No, you are not. Keep worshiping. Eventually He will minister even to your emotions. It is incredible what He will do.

In the middle of tribulation, because I am doing the right thing, tribulation employs patience. I have what I need to wait this thing out to victory.

Then patience says, "I am going to employ the kind of experience that causes me to end up with freedom."

Hebrews says milk is for the unskillful in the word of righteousness, but strong meat belongs to those who by reason of use have their senses exercised to discern both good and evil. I bring my senses under subjection to what the Word says, and that is helped by bold, violent, unhesitating worship for the position I have been proclaimed in Christ.

How does that help bring your senses under subjection to Him who said, "You are healed"?

"I have too much pain."

Then do what you need to do in the natural while you deal with the permanent problem. An action in the natural does not necessarily produce a reaction in the spiritual, but an action in the spiritual will always, without fail, cause a reaction in the natural.

Somebody asks, "Should I go to a doctor?"

If you ask me that, I will put you in the car. You are not ready for the fight. But once the doctor helps get you out of pain, why not learn what to do?

That action in the natural is not going to have the final say. If you start a reaction in the spiritual, it will trickle down and have a reaction in the natural.

Not only do I not have quitting sense, I am forgetting how to quit. An action in the spiritual will always cause a reaction in the natural, but an action in the natural does not necessarily cause a reaction in the spiritual.

"I was so weak I had to go to a doctor."

File it as a natural action that will not have the final say.

Doing the right thing in tribulation employs patience. Patience employs experience. Experience employs hope.

But here is the difference in this kind of hope: it is not the kind you mention at a funeral when you say, "There was a good person." It is not the kind that says, "I hope God will do something. He probably will not." That is the wrong kind of hope.

The kind of hope experience employs is the kind Hebrews 11 talks about:

"Now faith is the substance of things hoped for,
the evidence of things not seen."

If my faith is the substance of the thing I am hoping for before I have it, then fortunately faith only comes one way: by hearing, and hearing by the Word of God.

Faith does not come by my own personal opinion. It does not come by my own personal experiences, successes, or failures. It comes by hearing the Word.

Then the hope I have for receiving this thing had better be based on His Word.

"Do you think you are going to get it?"

"No, I do not think. I know."

"Why can you make a bold statement like that?"

"Because I have the substance of it already living in here."

In the beginning of the test, I did the right thing. I positioned myself in the Father, in the place of grace and blood that Jesus procured. It says, "It is finished, and it is mine." I will not detour. Nothing will change me.

Violently and vehemently, in the face of the devil, Pharaoh, the Red Sea, and everything else, I worship Him, proclaiming that this is done and that I am who He said I am.

This kind of hope makes not ashamed because the love of God is shed abroad in our hearts by the Holy Ghost who is given unto us.

Through private worship, vehemently proclaiming the position His Word gives you, not only saying it but fellowshiping with Him around it, glorifying Him, worshiping Him, loving Him, and getting to know Him, something explodes.

All of a sudden, the love of God comes flooding in on you and washes into your senses in baptism. He positions you and makes you not ashamed because He has picked you up, shed His love abroad in your heart, and caused you to receive what you have from Him.

That makes a person want to stop and worship God for the next forty minutes and call it church.

Maybe you will not get much done in forty minutes, but it may establish enough in you that you take another forty minutes, then another, and pretty soon you say, "This is better than nighttime television."

Someone was really going through a trial the other day, and I asked, "How are things?"

They said, "It is really great."

I said, "Really?" because I knew what they were going through.

"Oh, man, things are great."

"What do you base that on?"

"I am not in hell, am I?"

They missed everything and did not end up in hell. "I am not in hell, so it is great. It is great out here."

I love people who stand on the bow of the ship with a whole fleet in front of them, every cannon pointed at them, and when asked, "Do you surrender?" answer, "I have just begun to fight."

I would rather be a wet water-walker than a dry boat-sitter. The worst thing you can do is sit there and become passive. Imagine a child of God sitting passive. I do not think so.

For he edifies and continues to edify. This is part of interpretation. He loves the interaction where He gets to flow spontaneously, interact with you, speak His mind, flow, bless, and heal. This is all part of the edification process. This is all part of church.

He loves, through the gifts and the Word, to interact with you until He can step in at any time and do what His Word says.

He particularly loves it when you spontaneously fellowship with Him because, in your estimation, He is so good you have trouble not doing it.

Do you feel like victory looking for a place to manifest? Do you look like a trial that has a door opening out of it?

"There is no way I can get out."

That only shows how much you know God.

Do you feel like hope that is about to have a shedding abroad take place? Do you think God has the ability for you to go to bed one night and wake up the next day in a whole other world? Can He do that?

Yes. He carries the title God.

God came on us for a whole service and said, "Choose your battleground."

What do you want? Do you want to choose your own battleground, or do you want it chosen for you?

I would rather choose my own.

How do you do that? The devil keeps you defeated by keeping you from doing the right thing at the beginning of the process. You choose your battleground when the devil is successful through emotion, circumstances, and ugliness staring you in the face, and you say, "I know it is you. This is where we are fighting, because you are keeping me from going past this."

I am not going to wait until he takes something from me and then fight to hold onto it. I choose right now.

You know you have the football and you are heading for prayer, and he is trying to take it. So say, "Try to stop me again, devil. Feel free. Turn the lights out on the stadium. Everybody go home. I will follow you into the storage bin, get the football back, go back out to the field, and run."

When faith comes, you know as you run into prayer with that football that there is a goal in front of you. This is not running into empty air. This is not no results. This is where faith operates.

Every step you take, every time you fight your way past your emotions, worship Him, thank Him, and position yourself, know this inside: payday is coming.

Know it.

It is good when the war comes to the place where you are always celebrating.

"Are you not supposed to be fighting?"

"I am celebrating."

"What for?"

"For a victory I cannot see, but I know."

There is a supernatural infusion of His joy that will come. It comes when everything in the Spirit testifies, "For you, this is over."

I have taught for some time about a supernatural pleasure I was feeling from the Father. I know that when things drop off people and they do not attain to them, sometimes I feel like I did not do my job. But I started feeling a supernatural pleasure from the Father, knowing what God is: He is love.

Any manifestation that comes from Him toward me is something He has always had for me because He is love. I am simply coming to new levels of receiving.

I started feeling His pleasure, and I knew it was a manifestation of His love. He was so pleased with me, not because my life was winning battles or because I was established in a pending victory, but because of a recent turn in my heart that got blame off of God.

He had said to me, like Job's comforters, "There have been things said about Me that are not true."

My heart had actually attained to a position where it stopped accusing Him. My mouth had stopped years ago, but my heart was turning.

All doctrine seemed to be heading toward that point. Never before had my feelings come into such response to the Spirit that I felt something I could only define as His pleasure.

Jesus used the most drastic examples with me.

They asked about the man born blind, "Who sinned, this man or his parents?"

Jesus said, "Neither." He was the product of a fallen race. The only chance a child has is in the hands of strong believers before birth. There is nothing equal about the first birth the way there is about the second. In the second birth, you become a citizen of the kingdom with all rights, born equal with every other child of God.

Jesus said neither this man nor his parents sinned, but if He was going to work the works of Him who sent Him, He had to work while it was day. So He stepped in and opened the blind man's eyes.

If a child is born blind, it is because he is a victim of a fallen race. The curse showed up.

I have held many blind children in my arms, from wide eyes to no eyes. I had testimonies come back from overseas, but I had never held a baby and watched its eyes turn from white to pure.

I prayed for a dog the other day, and when the lumps did not instantly disappear, I wanted to blame the dog. I could not very well, because the dog did not have anything. Yet any animals under my jurisdiction have my blessing.

I certainly cannot blame the child.

So when this pleasure came, God cornered me and said, "If I do not heal this child when you pray, is it because I am the sovereign God who could have, but decided not to? Or did I not do it because I could not?"

I said, "It is in a believers' camp, a believers' church, surrounded by believers. What are You trying to say? If You do not do it, You are God and everyone here is hoping You will."

He said, "How much do you want?"

I said, "I want revival."

When believers teach the whole world faith from Tulsa and yet blind children go to church and come home blind until they grow up, something is wrong. Prosperity works, but can you see where the love of money aborted the children?

Sometimes we file things away by saying, "Some things belong to God and some things belong to men. God works in mysterious ways." That way we can keep our sanity while we journey through life, unable to explain the lack of God moving or answer sinners' questions when they probe a little past Sunday's message.

But God pressed me. "If I did not heal the baby, was it because I could have but would not?"

I stepped out there. My heart was stopping its accusation.

I said, "If You did not heal the baby, it was because You could not."

"But I am God."

"You still could not do it."

He said, "That is right. And the reason I could not is that I could not find enough in you to do it with."

That hurts.

He said, "Getting the blame off Me is your first step out of it."

Right after that, He started using cloths. Even through wireless phones, people were healed with no wire for the power to travel down. He brought healing power to a whole other level.

And the next level? He has been speaking about it in prophecy: do not coax darkness into where you hold your little candle vigils. Take My light out where darkness is. I will meet you where the curse manifests in humanity: among the deaf, mute, insane, and in children's hospitals. I will meet you everywhere at the cross in these places, son. I will manifest Myself in the middle of chaos, where people are looking for answers.

Romans 5:6 says:

"For when we were yet without strength,
in due time Christ died for the ungodly."

Then:

"For scarcely for a righteous man will one die:
yet peradventure for a good man
some would even dare to die.
But God commendeth his love toward us,
in that, while we were yet sinners,
Christ died for us."

Much more, being now justified by His blood, we shall be saved from wrath through Him. If He commended all that love toward us while we were sinners, how much more now that we have been justified by His blood?

When we were enemies, with no guarantee we would accept Him, He reconciled us to God by the death of His Son. How much more, being now reconciled, shall we be saved by His life?

Is there any end to what He will do for you, if He already did that much when you were His enemy?

I think I will quit resisting His love and see what He will do.

Verse 11 says:

"And not only so,
but we also joy in God
through our Lord Jesus Christ,
by whom we have now received the atonement."

What His pleasure translated into, finally, was the joy of the Lord. That is my strength.

Hear what the Spirit would say:

For most do not know this. Even as you choose not to be moved by what you see or feel, but accept only what I have said as truth, you who are mature have your senses exercised to discern both good and evil and are able to take your stand on the Word regardless of what circumstances say.

As you nurture your faith and build yourself up in what I have said about your victories, and even in what I have said about your defeats, know that there is only truth. Truth is the standard by which I measure all things.

Truth has the power within itself to be truth, and it stands alone. He that finds My truth has found the rock that is immovable, and he that does My sayings will not be moved.

As you give yourself to truth, know this: most are defeated on the line of their emotions. Most are overturned by the longevity of hopeless states. When time passes and there is no change, discouragement comes. Emotions grow strong and rise up to claim what is theirs.

Would I leave you in a fight to go from where your faith does not believe to where your faith does believe, based on My Word, without giving you keys along the way? Why would I not give you a hand up?

The pathway to the answer to your prayer is just as powerful, final, and settled as the answer and the miracle itself. Those who learn to put one foot in front of the other and walk the path I have laid to the miracle discover that I deal with the emotions along the way. I become part of your strength in emotion even before you see the manifestation of what you are believing for.

Many fight long battles. Most of the emotional onslaughts and weapons of the enemy are strongholds, systems of thought empowered by emotion. But I have separated all of you to Me. It does not matter your calling in the body; I have given all of you access to the same amount of who I am and what I am.

My victory is yours. When My victory becomes yours in your emotions and peace becomes the order of your day, persecution will be nothing to you. Persecution for My name's sake will not bear the kind of burden and grief that pulls you down in uncertainty and defeat, the kind that makes you sick and causes your body to fail.

There is a standing up under persecution that I ask you to do, but My peace is in that. My journey out of the things of the world to the rock that cannot be moved is also a journey of strength and victory for the things I will ask you to do.

With great victories, there is often great price. But great prices can be paid easily when your emotions and life are sustained on the rock that cannot be moved.

I looked here a little and there a little, line upon line and precept upon precept. I looked to the past and took My grace and attempted to pick many up and put them on the rock so I might teach them more. My desire was always a journey from glory to glory into My image.

It has brought Me great pleasure to find things in you that bring Me great pleasure. Many of you have not understood the weapon that has been formed in you. Not many wield this weapon forged in the flames of My fire, and many have been turned back.

But for you who accept this grace, I have shortened the journey that it took many to walk. Even as some neared the end of their lives and made their final contributions, they were on the line of not accomplishing all I gave them.

It has pleased Me to find things in you that, if you walk them out, will not be turned back. You will wield that weapon forged in My fires and make a short journey out of emotion into the stability of My rock.

Which do you desire: the long fight, where many receive not what they needed and become worn thin and discouraged, or the intensified but shortened fight, where you emerge victorious on the other side?

In the path to the rock, along the way, I extend My hand to those who want this sword of shortened battles.

There are few things you can do that excite the devil and cause him to organize his forces against you more than fellowshiping one-on-one with your Father through your new nature. That fellowship causes the Father to magnify His love for you in you and pour Himself out in you in a residency of His presence.

Filling your spirit causes such a baptism of your senses in glory and power that your emotions are not only sustained but forced back. The Word takes the place your emotions held and is released, because the war that used to win over you begins to lose. It could not win in your worship closet in the shorter period, though it had wanted to win over the longer period when you were not able to deal with your emotions.

Join My Word. Many do not understand this: as you speak My Word, as you minister to yourself in psalms, hymns, and spiritual songs, making melody in your heart to the Lord, giving thanks for all things to God and the Father, and as you worship and handle My Word on your lips in My presence, I pour My love into the unlimited capacities of your born-again spirit.

It is the residency of that love that begins the fight. The added ingredient that wins over emotions is My love magnified in you, sustaining you and causing you to win.

Many try without preparing their hearts, without baptizing themselves in My love, without spending time giving thanks for these things to God and the Father. Those who do not spend that time take the long road and are not fully equipped for the battle. Therefore many abort before their time.

I found pleasure, saith the Lord, because I have found enough to cause a people to know how to repeat the process and give instructions to win as finally as the victory.

How many of you are going to worship God privately more than you used to? How many want the short road?

When the battle intensifies, by then He intensifies in you faster. You are developing a key that has winners in it. This is the same key that gives me help when I say, "I need some help here."

I know He cannot love me any more. He does not have the deficit. But I found a key that lets me receive it on purpose.

What do you want to do, run all over the country looking at finished products, or stop and become one?

Do you want to keep running and buying people's books, or do you want books written about you?

You are destined for Him.